COMP-150: Introduction to Computing
SECTION 003 — Fall 2026

Instructor Information

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Course Information

Dates: Aug 24, 2026-Dec 12, 2026
Time:
  Section - 003: Tu 4:15PM - 6:45PM
Classroom:
  Section - 003: Information Commons - Room 216
Course Number:
  Section - 003: 2944
Final Exam:
  Section - 003: TBD - Fall 2026 Finals Week (Dec 7-12, 2026)
COMP150 Course Schedule: TBD (posted on Sakai)
COMP150 Course Website:
  Section - 003: https://sakai.luc.edu/portal/site/COMP_150_003_2944_1266
Course Syllabus Link: TBD (GitHub — to be posted)
Hands On Python:
  http://anh.cs.luc.edu/python/hands-on/3.1/handsonHtml/index.html
Learn Python the Right Way:
  https://learnpythontherightway.com/#read

Course Description

In our rapidly evolving digital age, computing literacy has become fundamental across every discipline. This course is a broad survey of computing — digital information, truth tables and Boolean logic, basic programming in Python, and major topics such as computer hardware, artificial intelligence, networking, and security — paired with a hands-on signature project: **engineering your own personal AI harness**.

Large language models like ChatGPT and Claude have transformed how we work with computers. Rather than treating AI as a black box, students in this course will learn how modern AI harnesses (agentic coding and assistant systems) are built and extended. Each student will be given access to a **Pi coding-agent harness** and will progressively build tools, install and configure extensions, and customize their setup until they have a personal AI system that fits the way they think and work.

Alongside this project, we cover the traditional introduction-to-computing survey: how information is represented in binary, how truth tables and Boolean logic drive decisions, fundamental programming concepts (data types, selection, repetition, and functions) in Python, and a tour of core computer-science topics.

Through this course, students will:

- Master fundamental programming concepts (data types, Boolean logic, selection, repetition, functions) in Python
- Understand how digital information is represented and how truth tables model computation
- Build and extend a personal AI harness — creating custom tools and integrating existing extensions
- Learn to work effectively, ethically, and critically with AI coding assistants as engineering partners
- Survey major areas of computing including hardware, artificial intelligence, networking, and security
- Develop critical thinking about how computing and AI systems shape society

This course is designed to empower students from all disciplines to understand, critique, and build the computing and AI systems that increasingly mediate our world.

Prerequisites: None.

While primarily designed as a terminal course for non-computer science majors, this course also offers valuable perspectives for computer science students seeking to understand the broader implications of their field.

Required equipment: You must bring a **laptop** to every class session. This course involves running and extending a coding-agent harness and writing code, so a laptop is required — a phone or tablet does not suffice. If you anticipate any difficulty meeting this requirement, please reach out via email before Add/Drop closes so we can help you find a solution.

Course Objectives

- To provide understanding of how digital information is represented, processed, and utilized in modern computing systems and their impact on daily life.
- To develop computational thinking skills through problem decomposition, pattern recognition, and algorithmic problem-solving.
- To provide foundational programming skills in Python, including working with data types, control structures (selection and repetition), functions, and basic data structures.
- To foster critical understanding of how software systems make decisions, process user data, and influence human behavior.
- To introduce modern software development practices including version control, debugging strategies, and effective use of AI-assisted programming tools.
- To design, build, and extend a personal AI harness — creating custom tools and integrating existing extensions to fit each student's own workflow.
- To explore diverse applications of computing across multiple domains including data science, artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, and web technologies.

- To develop awareness of ethical implications and societal impacts of computing technology and algorithmic decision-making.

Course Outcomes

- To provide the essential concepts of digital information and their relevance and impact on today's life.
- To provide an understanding of how hardware and software work together to create tools that the world uses every day. This component includes an introduction to digital logic and computer organization.
- To provide and introduce major concepts in computer programming using Python. This programming component teaches how to work with basic data types, operations, selection, repetition, and functions.
- To increase understanding of a broad range of topics in the field of computing such as artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, and networking.

Course Format

Two Strands, Woven Together

This course runs two complementary strands at the same time (not either/or):

- **Exposure** — a broad survey of computing ideas: digital information, digital logic & hardware, artificial intelligence, computer networks, and security & privacy.
- **Practice** — hands-on work: Python fundamentals, data-science labs, and building/owning your own personal **AI harness**.

The AI Harness (your own, on your own machine)

A signature part of this course is **digital agency**: you will set up and own a personal AI "harness" — a coding-agent system — on your own laptop, kept in your own private GitHub repository, configured to work the way you think. In the first half everyone builds a working barebones harness from scratch (so you understand what it really is). After the midterm you personalize it, and for the final project you use it with real data. Model access is via a free Google Gemini API key (no credit card required); setup details will be provided.

Key Dates (firm)

Date	**Event**
Tue Aug 25	First class
Fri Oct 2, 11:00 PM	Current Events in AI paper — official due
Mon–Tue Oct 5–6	Mid-Semester Break (no class Oct 6)
Wed Oct 14, 11:00 PM	AI paper — grace deadline (no penalty)
Fri Oct 30	Last day to withdraw with "W"
Tue Nov 24	Class meets (Thanksgiving Break Nov 25–28)
Tue Dec 1	Last class — final project presentations
Dec 7–12	Final Exam (slot TBD)

Deadlines at night are due at 11:00 PM (not midnight).

Tentative Flow (subject to change)

Because there is no timed midterm exam, we keep flexibility to spend more or less time on a topic as the class needs it. The following is a rough plan, **not** a fixed contract — always check Sakai for the current week.

- **Foundations (first half):** Digital information + Python fundamentals, while everyone builds a working barebones AI harness.
- **After the break:** the computing survey (digital logic & hardware, AI, networks, security) alongside data-science labs, personalizing your harness, and a final group data-science project that you will present.

Weekly Class Structure (2.5 hours, typical)

- **Lecture & concept introduction** — new ideas, stories, live demos
- **Homework / project review** — discussing the previous week
- **Break**
- **Group worksheet or lab** — collaborative, in-class (present-only credit)
- **Hands-on time** — start the week's work (harness / Python / data)

Assignment Types

- **In-class work:** worksheets, quizzes, and check-ins done during class — these can only be earned by attending.
- **Homework:** roughly ten assignments spread across the term. In some weeks the in-class lab is that week's homework.
- **AI harness:** building your barebones harness (first half) and personalizing it (second half).
- **Current Events in AI paper:** a short writing assignment (your "midterm").
- **Final group data-science project:** groups of 2–3, using data + your harness to answer a question or build something, then present it.
- **Final exam:** the one seated exam — cumulative, high-level, and you may bring a one-page notes/"cheat" sheet.

Grading Structure (Total: 1000 points)

Component	Points
In-class work (present-only; lowest 1–2 dropped)	300
Homework (~10 assignments)	200
AI harness: 0 → working (first half)	75
Current Events in AI paper ("midterm")	50
AI harness personalization (second half)	125
Final group data-science project (presented)	150
Final exam	100
Total	**1000**

Extra-credit opportunities (often hard or time-consuming) are offered throughout and are added on top. See the Grading Scale section for how points become letter grades, the attendance policy, and late-work rules.

AI and Large Language Model Usage Policy

Philosophy

In this course, AI assistants like ChatGPT, Claude, GitHub Copilot, and others are not just allowed—they are **encouraged** as learning partners. Just as calculators transformed mathematics education and spell-checkers changed writing instruction, AI coding assistants are transforming how we learn and write code. Our goal is to teach you to use these tools effectively, ethically, and critically.

When to Use AI (Encouraged)

- **Debugging:** When your code doesn't work, AI can help identify issues
- **Syntax Help:** Learning Python syntax and fixing syntax errors
- **Code Explanation:** Understanding what existing code does
- **Alternative Approaches:** Exploring different ways to solve a problem
- **Documentation:** Writing clear comments and docstrings
- **Learning Concepts:** Having concepts explained in different ways
- **Error Messages:** Understanding what error messages mean

How to Use AI Effectively

- **Start with Understanding:** Read the problem yourself first
- **Be Specific:** Ask targeted questions rather than "solve this for me"
- **Verify Output:** AI can be wrong—always test the code it provides
- **Learn from It:** Don't just copy—understand what the code does
- **Iterate:** If the first answer isn't right, refine your question
- **Document Usage:** Note when AI significantly helped your solution

What AI Cannot Do For You

- **Think Critically:** You must understand the problem and evaluate solutions
- **Make Design Decisions:** You choose the approach and structure
- **Test Thoroughly:** You must verify the code works correctly
- **Learn for You:** Using AI without understanding won't help on exams
- **Replace Practice:** Programming skills require hands-on practice

Academic Integrity with AI

- **Your Work:** The logic and problem-solving approach must be yours
- **Attribution:** Significant AI assistance should be acknowledged in comments
- **Exams:** Midterm and final exams will be completed without AI assistance
- **Understanding:** You must be able to explain any code you submit
- **Collaboration:** AI doesn't replace working with classmates

Example: Good vs. Problematic AI Use

Good Use:

```
You: "I'm trying to check if a number is even in Python but
     getting a syntax error. Here's my code: if x % 2 = 0:"
AI: "You need == for comparison, not =. Use: if x % 2 == 0:"
```

Problematic Use:

```
You: "Write a complete recommendation system for homework 3"
AI: [Provides complete solution]
You: [Submits without understanding]
```

AI Disclosure Statement

For major assignments, include a comment block describing your AI usage:

```
"""
AI Usage Disclosure:
- Used ChatGPT to debug index out of range error in line 45
- Asked Claude to explain how enumerate() works
- GitHub Copilot suggested the list comprehension on line 23
- Rest of logic and structure is my own work
"""
```

Remember

AI is a powerful tool, but it's just that—a tool. Just as using a calculator doesn't make you a mathematician, using AI doesn't make you a programmer. The goal is to understand programming concepts deeply enough that you could solve problems without AI, but efficiently enough that you know when and how to use AI to be more productive.

Think of AI as a knowledgeable tutor who's always available but sometimes makes mistakes. Use it wisely, and it will accelerate your learning. Use it blindly, and you'll struggle when it's not available.

Grading Scale

This course is graded on a **1000-point scale**. Every assignment, activity, and extra-credit opportunity is worth points — points are points. Your letter grade is determined from your total points earned, using approximately the following ranges (900+ = A):

930-1000	A
900-929	A-
870-899	B+
830-869	B
800-829	B-
770-799	C+
730-769	C
700-729	C-
670-699	D+
600-669	D
below 600	F

The curve only ever helps you. I may adjust these cutoffs downward based on where scores cluster (for example, setting the top cluster's lowest score as the A– line), but I never curve grades down and never force a bell curve. If you show up and do the work, you can earn an A.

Attendance and Missed Classes

This is a night class, and attendance matters. Every synchronous session includes graded in-class work (worksheets, quizzes, check-ins) worth points — roughly 300 points across the term — that **can only be earned by attending**. In-class work generally cannot be made up, though your lowest one or two scores are dropped to cover the occasional unavoidable absence.

Attendance policy (firm): Attendance is taken every class. **More than five (5) unexcused absences results in an automatic grade of D for the course**, regardless of your point total. Authorized/excused absences under the University's Undergraduate Attendance Policy do not count against this. If something serious is going on, talk to me early.

If you miss a class session, it is your responsibility to:

- Determine what you missed
- Locate any handouts
- Keep up to date on any changes in assignments, course plans, schedules, etc.

It is not the instructor's obligation to help you make up for missing class.

University Attendance Policy (Undergraduate)

The following is the University's Undergraduate Attendance Policy, which this course follows. Because participation/attendance is part of your grade, attendance is recorded throughout the term.

The undergraduate attendance policy specifies the role of students, instructors and university administrators in cases when students are absent from one or more classes.
The university does not require faculty to take attendance; however, if faculty use participation/attendance in their grading rubric, they must include this policy on the course syllabus which must clearly define the consequences

for non-attendance. If participation/attendance is identified as a portion of the students' final grade, faculty must maintain a record of students' attendance throughout the term.

Excused Absences. The university recognizes there are times when students must miss class due to extenuating circumstances. Regardless of the attendance policy of the faculty, the following are considered excused obligations and are not to be counted as absences in the class. Excused absences do not preclude the need to fulfill specific program requirements.

1. Jury duty, with appropriate documentation.
2. Short Term Military Obligation — Veterans Current Students. This activity must be documented and provided to the faculty in advance of the activity. The documentation must be verified by the director or assistant director in the Military Veteran Student Services Office, who has confirmed that the student has orders to report for a short-term military obligation.
3. Day(s) for Religious Observances.
4. Participation in Division-1 athletics or other university-sanctioned events (Travel & Competition Policy). This activity must be documented and provided to the faculty in advance of the activity, and verified by an administrator directly related to the activity (e.g., Division-1 athletics representative; musical group director; student development representative, etc.).
5. Absences resulting from legally mandated accommodation requirements (e.g., Title IX, ADA, etc.).
6. In the event of a state or national pandemic, the institution retains the right to amend this attendance policy.

Making Up Work from a Missed Class. The excused absences outlined above require the faculty to facilitate alternative means for students to make up classwork and/or get notes from a lecture. Labs, clinical hours, group work, performance, studio art, and other field-based classes are the exceptions to this because it may be impossible to make up classwork.

Unexcused Absences. Absences not listed above are unexcused. The ability to make up class work because of an unexcused absence is at the discretion of the faculty, as outlined in the faculty's attendance policy noted on this syllabus. Note that the Loyola University Chicago Wellness Center does not provide documentation for absences.

In this course, the "more than five unexcused absences results in a D" rule above applies only to **unexcused** absences; the excused categories listed here are never counted against you.

Extra Credit

Extra-credit opportunities (often deliberately challenging or time-consuming) are offered to the whole class throughout the semester, and can add a meaningful number of points on top of the 1000. Please do not ask for personal extra credit to improve your individual grade — that would not be fair to your classmates. Extra credit is always offered to everyone equally.

Tools and Submitting Work

We use a small set of low-friction tools; specifics and links are always posted on Sakai:

- **Sakai:** the hub for the schedule, assignments, quizzes, and announcements.
- **Python work:** done in a browser-based notebook environment (e.g., Google Colab) — no install needed.
- **Your AI harness:** installed on your own laptop and kept in your own private GitHub repository.

- **Submitting:** follow the per-assignment instructions on Sakai and submit before the deadline.
- **Academic Integrity:** ensure all submitted work is your own.

Assignment Submission and Grading Policies

- Submit your written assignments on Sakai as a PDF file unless otherwise instructed.
- Include other required files (e.g., screenshots) by adding them to a document and saving as PDF.
- Assignments should be completed and submitted by the official due date. However, as long as no grade has been posted in Sakai, you are encouraged to continue working on the assignment even if it is past the deadline.
- Assignments submitted after the due date will be subject to the following conditions:
  - Penalties, if any, will be applied on a case-by-case basis.
  - You are responsible for notifying me when your late submission is ready to be graded or regraded.
- Occasionally, you may receive a provisional grade on an assignment with the opportunity to improve your work and have it regraded. In these cases, the late submission policy outlined above will apply.
- While this flexible system is designed to support your learning, it is not intended to encourage procrastination or neglect of deadlines. All other assessments (e.g., online and in-person quizzes, midterms, and final exams) must be completed on time and will not be accepted late under any circumstances.
- Begin work on assignments as soon as they are posted—most cannot be completed in one day.
- Grade disputes must be raised within ONE week after the grade is posted.

Computer Science Tutoring

Tutoring is available from the computer science department for additional help:

- Especially useful for on-campus students
- Official Tutoring Center in the Sullivan Center (extension 8-7708)
- Website: https://www.luc.edu/cs/resources/tutoring/
- Appointments may be required in advance
- COMP students have generally done better with the department's tutoring service

Loyola Admin Course Info

Religious Observance

Students with religious holiday conflicts: Please notify me within the first two weeks of class if you have a religious holiday conflict with any exam or homework due date so that we can plan any necessary accommodations.

Accommodations for Students with Disabilities

Loyola University provides reasonable accommodations for students with disabilities. Any student requesting accommodations related to a disability or other condition is required to register with the Student Accessibility Center (SAC), located in Sullivan Center, Suite 117. Professors receive accommodation notifications from SAC via Accommodate. Students are encouraged to meet with their professors individually to discuss their accommodations. All information will remain confidential.

Please note that in this class, software may be used to record class lectures to provide equal access to students with disabilities. Students approved for this accommodation may use recordings for their personal study only and may not share these recordings with other people or use them in any way against the faculty member, other lecturers, or students whose classroom comments are recorded as part of the class activity. Recordings are deleted at the end of the semester.

For more information about registering with SAC or questions about accommodations, please contact SAC at 773-508-3700 or SAC@luc.edu.

If you have a documented disability and wish to discuss academic accommodations, please contact the Services for Students with Disabilities Office (773-508-3700 and SSWD@luc.edu) as soon as possible. Students with documented disabilities who provide me with a letter from the SSWD office will be fully accommodated as per the terms of the letter. Students who are allowed to take their exams in the SSWD office are encouraged to do so. In this course, quizzes may be taken outside of class, so you will most likely not require a separate testing location. However, if you need extra time, please let me know as soon as possible.

No medical or disability accommodations can be provided beyond what SAC specifies. Accommodations cannot be provided retroactively. Please do not send me doctor's notes or any personal medical information, unless there is some unforeseen medical emergency that a SAC accommodation cannot cover.

Students with Sponsorships and Scholarships

If you require a certain grade to satisfy a sponsor or a scholarship requirement, please be sure to monitor your grade on Sakai. I will consider only your performance in this course in calculating grades, using the grading rubric posted in this syllabus. If you cannot achieve the minimum grade required by a sponsor or a scholarship, I will not change your grade to help you meet that requirement. This would be unfair to other students, and not reflective of your performance in this course. You are responsible for monitoring your grade and keeping apprised of the withdrawal dates posted by the registrar.

Incomplete Grades

An incomplete grade will not be given, except in the case of a serious family or personal emergency. A written excuse with a legitimately verifiable reason must be provided.

External Tools and Resources

As aspiring digital citizens, it's vital to utilize the internet and resources such as StackOverflow, blogs, and GitHub to find solutions to programming problems. However, it's essential to approach these resources responsibly:

- **General Guidance**: Use solutions found online as reference implementations to study and help craft your solution. Try to solve the problem yourself first and ensure that you fully understand any code you write.
- **Generative AI Usage (e.g., ChatGPT, Claude, Grok, Deepseek, Gemini)**:
  - Gaining fluency in programming requires trial and error.

  - COMP-150 students are strongly encouraged to use Generative AI as a primary means to obtain solutions.
  - Use requires citation, and critical evaluation of the output is expected.
  - Cheating with LLMs will only be penalized when their use is explicitly not allowed

- **Writing Assistance Tools**:
  - Utilize tools like Grammarly to identify and correct grammatical errors, spelling mistakes, and punctuation issues.
  - Your work may be penalized if unclear writing arises from not using such tools.

- **Direct Copying**: Copying and pasting code directly from external resources, including generative AI, is considered cheating and academic dishonesty.

Academic Honesty

Students are expected to have read the statement on academic integrity available at: http://www.luc.edu/academics/catalog/undergrad/reg_academicintegrity.shtml

This policy applies to this course. The minimum penalty for academic dishonesty is a grade of F for that assignment. Multiple instances or a single severe instance on a major exam or assignment may result in a grade of F for the course. All cases of academic dishonesty will be reported to the department office and the relevant college office and placed in your school record.

Gender Misconduct Mandatory Reporting

Loyola University Chicago faculty are committed to supporting our students and upholding gender equity laws as outlined by Title IX. Therefore, if a student chooses to confide in a member of Loyola's faculty or staff regarding an issue of gender-based misconduct (including sexual harassment, sexual assault, dating/domestic violence, or stalking), that faculty or staff member is obligated to tell Loyola's Title IX Deputy Coordinator. The Title IX Deputy Coordinator will assist the student in connecting with all possible resources for support and reporting on and off campus.

Mental Health and Wellness

During the semester, if you find that health problems, life stressors, or emotional difficulties are interfering with your academic or personal success, and you are therefore finding it difficult to cope or to complete your academic work, please consider contacting the Wellness Center. Healthcare services, crisis intervention, time-limited individual counseling, and group therapies are free of charge and strictly confidential, having nothing to do with your educational records.

You can make an appointment online. You may also call 773-508-2530 for counseling appointments or 773-508-8883 to speak with a nurse about medical concerns. More information is available at the Wellness Center website. If your medical or mental health condition requires ongoing academic accommodations, please register with Student Accessibility Services: https://www.luc.edu/sac/ and provide me with a copy of your accommodation letter.

Continuous Improvement

We believe in a personal quality process of continuous improvement. Anything can be improved by applying the quality process of "Plan, Do, Check, Act" (PDCA). To improve the course and the learning of programming, Python, and computer science concepts, we welcome your feedback, comments, suggestions, and complaints at any time.

In support of this PDCA process, we may ask you to participate in surveys and discussions during the course. These surveys will measure student impressions of the course; when time permits, we will share the results with the class. Your inputs on these surveys are anonymous and in no way affect your grade.

We will also be using a LUC feedback system called SmartEvals toward the end of the course to gather your feedback on both the course itself and our teaching. We use this feedback to improve how we teach the information in the course, and the CS Department uses it to help refresh and improve our course offerings.

Classroom Rules Of Engagement

The following guidelines are in place to ensure a respectful and productive learning environment for everyone. Adherence to these policies is expected from all participants in the course, including students, instructors, and teaching assistants.

Student Responsibilities:

- *Classroom Behavior*:
  - **Attendance**: Regular attendance is encouraged. Please refer to the syllabus for specific policies on excused and unexcused absences.
  - **Communication**: Raise your hand if you wish to speak during class. Respectful listening and interaction with peers are expected. Jot down any questions you have during class in case we don't have time to answer them the moment you think of them.
  - **Technology**: Use of phones or computers to communicate with people outside of class during class time is prohibited. Use of recording devices must be approved by the instructor.
  - **Food and Drink**: Avoid bringing messy or disruptive food or beverages to class. Class and office hours run through normal dinner hours, so feel encouraged to bring food with you to stay engaged.
  - **Masks**: Wearing a mask is permitted and must follow current university or public health guidelines.
  - **Prohibited Substances**: Smoking or the use of recreational drugs in class is strictly prohibited.
  - **Listening to music**: Listening to music while the instructor is giving a lecture is rude. If you find you work better with an earbud in during the portions of the classes dedicated to individual or group discussion, that may be permitted.
  - **Participation**: Active participation in class discussions and activities is expected.
  - **Respect for Diverse Opinions**: Engage with and respect diverse viewpoints. Civil discourse is expected at all times.
  - **Confidentiality**: Respect the confidentiality of information shared in class, especially during in-class discussions.

Staff Responsibilities:

- *Professional Conduct*:
  - **Punctuality**: Instructors and TAs will arrive at class on time and well-prepared.
  - **Availability**: Instructors and TAs will be available for assistance and questions during designated office hours or by appointment.
  - **Timely Grading**: Assignments will be graded and returned promptly, with clear feedback to support student learning.

- **Syllabus Changes**: The syllabus and schedule may be subject to change with proper notice.

These guidelines are essential for maintaining a positive classroom environment where everyone can learn and grow. If you have any questions or concerns about these policies, please discuss them with the course instructor or TA. Failure to adhere to these guidelines may result in disciplinary action as per university policy.

Use of Computers in Class

Computers and other electronic devices are powerful tools for learning, but they must be used appropriately during class. The following guidelines apply to the use of computers in this course:

- **Permitted Use**: Computers may be used during lectures and in-class lab work for note-taking, accessing course materials, coding exercises, and other course-related activities.
- **Prohibited Use**: During certain class activities, such as class discussions, guest speakers, or specific instructions from the instructor, computers must be closed and put away. Unauthorized browsing, social media use, or engaging in activities unrelated to the course is not allowed during class.
- **Examinations**: All examinations, including quizzes and midterms, will be conducted using pen and paper. Computers, smartphones, and other electronic devices are strictly prohibited during exams.
- **Respectful Use**: Be mindful of your classmates and the instructor by using computers that do not distract others. Mute all notifications and use headphones if necessary.
- **Accessibility**: If you have specific accessibility needs requiring a computer or other assistive technology, please communicate with the instructor to make appropriate accommodations.

Adherence to these guidelines ensures a focused and collaborative learning environment. Failure to comply with these rules may result in loss of participation points or other penalties as determined by the instructor.

Email Etiquette

Email communication is an essential part of academic and professional life. The following guidelines should be followed when communicating with the course instructor, teaching assistants, or fellow students via email:

- **Subject Line**: Begin the subject line with the course number, followed by a colon, section number (e.g., "001", "002"), and a specific description that reflects the content of the email (e.g., "COMP150: Section 001: Question about Homework 3").
- **Respectful Address**: Begin the email with a respectful salutation, addressing the recipient in a manner they prefer, such as "Dear Prof Miller," "Dear Instructor Miller," "Dear Allan," or "Dear Mr. Miller."
- **Clear Communication**: Write your email in complete sentences, using proper grammar and punctuation. Be concise and articulate your question or request clearly. Tools like Grammarly can assist with identifying and correcting grammatical errors.
- **Signature**: Include your full name, student ID, and the course name/section at the end of the email.
- **Timeliness**: Allow reasonable time for a response, typically 24-48 hours during the working week. Avoid sending urgent emails outside of normal working hours.
- **Attachments**: If attaching files, make sure they are in a commonly accepted format and include a brief description in the email.

- **Respect and Courtesy**: Maintain a respectful and courteous tone throughout the email, remembering that tone can be misinterpreted in written communication.
- **Privacy**: Be mindful of privacy concerns and avoid sharing sensitive or personal information via email unless necessary.

Adhering to these guidelines fosters professional communication and helps ensure that your emails are read and responded to in a timely manner. If your email pertains to something that can be discussed in class or during office hours, consider addressing it in person instead.

Course Adjustments

The course calendar and syllabus can be changed at ANY time based on the progress of the class and the speed at which the content is covered during class sessions. Any changes will be communicated to students in a timely manner.